Why Zion — Website Copy

Oct 23, 2026 · @Landon

Notes for Claude Code

- This is final, approved copy for the Zion Bonsai website. Use the wording exactly as written; don't rephrase or shorten it.
- **Short version** goes on the homepage as a "Why Zion?" section.
- **Long version** goes on the About page as a "Why Zion?" section.
- In the long version, Landon's Zeus story is a direct quote. Style it as a pull quote or blockquote so it reads in his voice.
- Keep "Mormon caffeine" as written — it's intentional.
- Brand: terracotta/coral and sage green palette; Montserrat Bold for headings, Open Sans for body. Tone is warm and personal, so give the copy room to breathe rather than packing it into cards.

Short version (homepage)

Why Zion?

Our name comes from two places close to our hearts. The first is Zion National Park, where the red rock and quiet canyons showed us what peace feels like. The second is what Zion means: a people of one heart and one mind. That idea is rooted in our faith and shared by many traditions. Through the ancient art of bonsai, we want to help nurture the Zion in all of us, connecting us to nature, to God, and to each other. Ten minutes a day with a tree can settle a busy mind and help us show up a little calmer, a little kinder, and more present for the people around us.

Long version (About page)

Why Zion?

The name started with a place. We spent the first eight years of our marriage in St. George, and Zion National Park became one of the places we felt most at peace: the red rock, the wide vistas, the stillness. Those colors are woven into everything we make,

because we want our workshops to feel the way that canyon feels.

But Zion means more to us than a park. In our faith as members of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, Zion describes a people "of one heart and one mind," a oneness we try to build in our home and our community. That hope isn't ours alone. It echoes through the Hebrew psalms, through the Christian longing for a city of peace, and through the quiet traditions bonsai itself grew from. Through the ancient art of bonsai, we want to help nurture the Zion in all of us: connection to nature, to God, and to each other.

Our trees have a way of teaching us along the way. Landon puts it like this:

> "Zeus taught me a lot about not fighting things you can't control. He was basically a side branch forced into becoming a main trunk, and despite my early mistakes, he never stalled out. He just rerouted his energy and kept going. Plants don't care about the setback; they just adapt and put out new leaves. It's been a really good reminder that you can't always pick the situation, but you can always decide where to put your energy."

For us, a lot of that energy goes into small things, like taking an extra fifteen seconds to look the cashier in the eye, say hello, and really ask how they're doing. At seventeen, Cass worked as a housekeeper and learned firsthand how it feels when people look through you instead of at you. When Landon worked at Dixie State University (now Utah Tech University), he knew everyone by name, from the custodian who emptied his office trash to the vice presidents. People are people. Titles shouldn't matter.

Bonsai gives us room to practice that. Some days our ten minutes with the trees is just watering them, or sitting and taking in their beauty. That's often enough to quiet an anxious mind so we can show up a little calmer. Other days, "I'll trim this one tree" turns into hours of shaping half the collection. Either way, time with a tree, spent reflecting on the blessings we've been given, makes us a little more whole.

This is how we try to show up for our boys, our friends, and the wonderful people at our local gas station, who see us several times a day for our daily dose of Mormon caffeine. And it's what we hope you'll find in a workshop: a little more of the Zion in you.